

The Power Of Seeing

The most valuable thing on a project can be noticing the gap between the map and the reality.

The Beautiful Map

A regional bank team was fixing slow loan decisioning. A green belt built a gorgeous map, twenty-two boxes, five swimlanes, color-coded by department. Leadership loved it. But he built it entirely in a conference room from manager interviews, based on how the process was supposed to work, not how it actually ran.

Going To Look

The simple contribution was sitting with a junior loan officer for an afternoon and watching the real work. Seven steps on the map no longer happened. Four steps that happened every day were nowhere on it. The map was quietly, expensively wrong because nobody had checked it against reality.

The Hidden Step

To get one number, the officer exported a file, emailed it to herself, opened it in another system, fixed the formatting by hand, and re-uploaded it. That workaround added about eight days of waiting per loan, most of the delay the project was chartered to fix. It was invisible until someone watched the work happen.

Remember this

AI helps you draw fast, but the truth comes from a human willing to go and look.